



YOU ARE **16 WEEKS 3 DAYS**

165 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This 3D scan is taken from a viewpoint above the baby's head and looking over the shoulder, but since the baby is curled up the face cannot be seen. The placenta is to the right of the image, with the umbilical cord over the baby's arm.

“While you're pregnant, it's even more important to find ways to relieve stress and keep any worries in perspective.”

You may be pregnant and happy, but life goes on: this means you might still be working full time, in addition to running a home, and you're bound to have stressful days and times when you feel you can't manage. And, of course, even though you are in the second trimester now, you're still contending with those challenging pregnancy hormones that can cause some emotional ups and downs.

Like many women, you may become stressed about the big changes that are going to happen—there's no greater life change than becoming a parent—and worry about factors such as finances, whether you'll be a good mother, and how your relationship will change. It's important to keep worries in perspective and try to maintain an emotional balance since being stressed isn't good for your health or the health of your baby.

Find simple ways to handle and reduce your stress—see below for some suggestions. Activities such as going swimming may take some planning, but try to find a slot in your schedule to make time for this every week.

Sometimes relieving stress can be as simple as sharing it, so talk to others to put your concerns in perspective. Or if you don't want to share your worries, write them down instead.

RELIEVING STRESS

Learn to recognize the signs that you're stressed: you may feel your heart racing or a rise in your body temperature. When you know you're stressed, take action.

- **Identify the cause** and try to keep it in perspective. Let go of the stress by breathing deeply and relaxing your muscles. Imagine blowing the stress away as you exhale.
- **Stay busy**—sometimes having too much time to think can make you more stressed.
- **Going swimming** is a great stress reliever and a great way to stay in shape.
- **Take time to relax**, especially if you have a lot on your mind or are juggling lots of things. Put your feet up, watch TV, read a book, or just spend quiet time thinking about your growing baby.